

The Web started from bulletin board services and forums and has evolved to a more complex method of social interaction—social networking sites. The sites offer a safe, secure and fun-filled way for people to connect, interact and socialise on the Internet. We did some research on the popular as well as and not-so-popular sites, and cover ten of them here:

- Facebook
- Orkut
- Fropper
- BigAdda
- Yaari
- MySpace
- Friendster
- OkCupid
- Hi5
- Forums

## 5.1 Orkut

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Orkut is the site to start with. Who has not heard of Orkut? Started a few years ago, this is perhaps the most popular social networking site amongst Indians. The site has been developed by Google, and your Google Account login works here too.

If you do not already have a Google Account, this site will help you get one. Google sends you an activation link to your email account and once you click on it, your account is activated. When you sign in, the first thing you want to do is enter your complete personal details. Click on the “Edit Profile” link to the left of the page and you are taken to a page showing four links. Click on the general link to enter basic information about you. This includes information like age, interests, hobbies, favourite music and movies. Click on the social link to enter information about your height, looks and your ideal match. The contact link is used to enter your contact information such as your e-mail ID, your cell number and your address. The last link, professional, lets you key in information about your professional life. In your profile, you can decide on the information fields that should be